BARRISTON
LAW

September 17, 2024

SENT BY EMAIL TO: ADMIN@NIPISSINGTOWNSHIP.COM

Township of Nipissing
45 Beatty Street
Nipissing, ON P0H 1W0

Attention: Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator-Clerk-Treasurer

Dear Ms. Croskery-Hodgins:

RE: REQUEST FOR REPORT
FILE NO. 115383

Please accept this letter, as my report to Council on my recent activities as the Township's Integrity Commissioner.

On May 24, 2024, I received a lengthy email complaint from a resident, made under the Township's Code of Conduct. The complaint raised concerns about two matters: damage to the marsh associated with the Township's ice-fishing parking lot; and the treatment afforded to candidates at the Special Meeting of Council on May 9, 2024.

To familiarize myself with the issues, I watched the recording of the May 9th meeting and spoke at some length with the complainant. Although my work is to remain largely confidential, after viewing the July 17, 2024 meeting of Council, I would like to clarify my response to the resident.

On the concern over damage to the marsh, it was my advice that this was not within my jurisdiction as the Township's integrity commissioner and that I could provide no assistance.

On the suggestion that candidates were treated disrespectfully at the May 9th meeting, it was my opinion that, in fact, all candidates were treated respectfully, including the complainant. I did suggest to the resident that I would need to hear directly from a candidate as to whether he or she felt they had been treated unfairly. I can confirm that I heard nothing further from the resident or any of the other candidates and that I have not commenced an investigation. As is my practice when I decline to commence an inquiry, I did not notify Council of my decision not to investigate.

I trust that you will find this to be useful and would, of course, be pleased to answer any questions you may have.

Yours very truly,
BARRISTON

Per Harold G. Elston
/KV